CURRICULUM VITÆ

Xiaotian YE

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Education

Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications — **Beijing, China**
B.Eng. in Computer Science — Sep. 2022 – Jun. 2026

- **Overall GPA:** 92.32/100, 3.83/4.00
- **Activities and societies:** Member of ICPC Programming Team *(Gold medal in BUPT Campus Programming Contest for Freshmen, which is the team formation contest).*
- **Coursework:** Machine Learning (95), Design and Analysis of Algorithms (98), Data Structures (97), Python Programming (99), Matrix Theory (99), Foundation of Programming (98), Computer Systems (95), Formal Languages and Automata (96), Big Data Technology (97), Operating Systems (94), etc.

Research Interests

Focus on the intersection of **knowledge mechanisms** and the **safety & trustworthiness** of foundation models (LLMs/VLMs), aiming to address three core research questions:

- How can we interpret the internal knowledge mechanisms of LLMs?
- How can we control and modify knowledge within LLMs to enhance trustworthiness and safety?
- How can we leverage such controllability to build safer and more trustworthy real-world AI systems?

Publications & Manuscripts

Google Scholar · Semantic Scholar · DBLP

Research Highlights (* equal contribution)

[1] **LLM Unlearning Should Be Form-Independent**
Xiaotian Ye, Mengqi Zhang, Shu Wu
IEEE S&P 2026

[2] **Uncovering Overfitting in Large Language Model Editing**
Mengqi Zhang*, **Xiaotian Ye***, Qiang Liu, Pengjie Ren, Shu Wu, Zhumin Chen
ICLR 2025 Spotlight

[3] **Knowledge Graph Enhanced Large Language Model Editing**
Mengqi Zhang*, **Xiaotian Ye***, Qiang Liu, Pengjie Ren, Shu Wu, Zhumin Chen
EMNLP 2024

Other Publications & Preprints

[4] **Monte-Carlo Interpretability Analysis on Knowledge Editing and Its Generalization Failure**
Xiaotian Ye, ChunYao Yang, Mengqi Zhang, Xiaohan Wang, Dongsheng Liu, Shu Wu
Preprint, in submission to ICML 2026

[5] **Disentangling Knowledge Representations for Large Language Model Editing**
Mengqi Zhang*, Zisheng Zhou*, **Xiaotian Ye**, Zhaochun Ren, Zhumin Chen, Pengjie Ren
ICLR 2026

[6] **UIPE: Enhancing LLM Unlearning by Removing Knowledge Related to Forgetting Targets**
Wenyu Wang*, Mengqi Zhang*, **Xiaotian Ye**, Zhaochun Ren, Zhumin Chen, Pengjie Ren
EMNLP 2025 Findings

[7] **KELE: Residual Knowledge Erasure for Enhanced Multi-hop Reasoning in Knowledge Editing**
Mengqi Zhang*, Bowen Fang*, Qiang Liu, **Xiaotian Ye**, Shu Wu, Pengjie Ren, Zhumin Chen et al.
EMNLP 2025 Findings

[8] **Towards Understanding the Effect of NTP Paradigm in Unstructured Knowledge Editing**
Zisheng Zhou, Mengqi Zhang, Shiguang Wu, **Xiaotian Ye**, Chi Zhang, Zhumin Chen et al.
Preprint, in submission to ICML 2026

[9] **Spectral Characterization and Mitigation of Sequential Knowledge Editing Collapse**
Chi Zhang, Mengqi Zhang, **Xiaotian Ye**, Runxi Cheng, Zisheng Zhou, Pengjie Ren, Zhumin Chen
Preprint, in submission to ACL 2026

[10] **Open Problems and a Hypothetical Path Forward in LLM Knowledge Paradigms**
Xiaotian Ye, Mengqi Zhang, Shu Wu
Blogpost preprint, in submission

Internship / Research Experience

Institute of Automation, Chinese Academy of Sciences — **Beijing, China**
Research Intern — NLPR & MAIS (State Key Lab of Multimodal AI Systems) — Jun. 2023 – Present

- Supervised by Prof. Shu Wu; working with Dr. Mengqi Zhang.
- **Project 1: Knowledge Editing and Unlearning of LLMs.** Contributed across the full research pipeline (survey, coding, experiments, rebuttal, and camera-ready), serving as a primary contributor for three papers: (1) proposed a knowledge graph–enhanced editing framework (EMNLP 2024), (2) first identified and analyzed overfitting phenomena in model editing (ICLR 2025 Spotlight), and (3) independently conducted research analyzing form-dependent bias in unlearning (S&P 2026, top security venue), receiving near-Distinguished Paper level scores with a fully positive meta-review. Also co-authored five additional papers (2×EMNLP 2025 Findings, 1×ICLR 2026, 2 papers under review at ICML/ACL).
- **Project 2: Interpretability Analysis of LLM Knowledge Representation.** Leading a project that proposes a new class of interpretability tool by applying Monte Carlo-based sampling of latent representations and gradient-based analysis to study distributional properties of knowledge vectors and their solutions, explaining why representation-level control methods such as knowledge editing struggle to generalize. In submission to ICML 2026 as first author.
- **Project 3: Concept-Centric Safety Alignment for LLMs.** Leading a project that investigates concept-level alignment strategies encouraging models to align directly to harmful concepts rather than surface tokens, mitigating previously observed overfitting to literal lexical patterns and improving generalization under extreme OOD adversarial settings. Targeting NeurIPS 2026 as first author.

Selected Awards & Honors

2025 CCF Elite Collegiate Award (Annually awarded to 100 undergraduates nationwide; each top-tier university nominates up to 4 candidates)

2023 International Silver Medal ICPC, Asia Regional Contest

2023 National Silver Medal China Collegiate Programming Contest

2023 Merit Student Beijing University of Posts and Telecommunications

2023 National First Prize National English Competition for College Students, Final

2023 National Individual Third Prize CCCC-GPLT, National Final

Professional Service

Conference Reviewer ICML 2026

Skills

- **Programming:** Especially experienced in Python, C++ and C; comfortable with JavaScript and Java. Experienced in programming under Unix-like environments including Linux. Experienced in Competitive Programming.
- **Machine Learning:** Experienced in PyTorch and NumPy; strong knowledge of theories and methods in machine learning and LLMs, especially in LLM knowledge and interpretability.
- **English Proficiency:** TOEFL BestScore 112 (R 29, L 30, S 25, W 28). Proficient in academic reading and writing.

Last updated: March 2026